

1 ENGROSSED HOUSE
2 CONCURRENT

3 RESOLUTION NO. 1024

By: Hildebrant and Cornwell of
the House

and

Seifried of the Senate

8 A Resolution designating April 21 as Route 66 Day;
9 recognizing individual's contribution to Route 66 in
10 Oklahoma; recognizing the cultural and economic
11 impact of Route 66 in Oklahoma; and providing for
12 distribution.

13 WHEREAS, the Bureau of Public Roads, the predecessor to the U.S.
14 Department of Transportation, officially approved the national
15 highway system on November 11, 1926, making 2026 the one hundredth
16 anniversary of Route 66; and

17 WHEREAS, Cyrus Stevens Avery from Tulsa, Oklahoma, was appointed
18 chairman of the Oklahoma Highway Commission in 1924 and through this
19 role he was instrumental in determining the path of Route 66 from
20 Chicago to Los Angeles; and

21 WHEREAS, Cyrus Avery and B.P. Piepmeier sent a telegram to the
22 Bureau of Public Roads in Washington, D.C., on April 30, 1926,
23 accepting the designation of the route from Chicago to Los Angeles
24 as Highway 66; and

1 WHEREAS, Cherokee citizen, Andy Payne, from Foyil, Oklahoma, won
2 the "Bunion Derby" in 1928, a 3,423-mile transcontinental race from
3 Los Angeles to New York in 573 hours, 4 minutes, and 34 seconds,
4 conceived by sports promoter Charles Pyle to promote Route 66; and

5 WHEREAS, in 1935, the U.S. Highway 66 Association designated
6 Route 66 as the "Will Rogers Highway" in honor of Will Rogers,
7 Oklahoma's favorite son; and

8 WHEREAS, Oklahoma has over 400 drivable miles of Route 66 today,
9 more than any other state; and

10 WHEREAS, Oklahoma counties with a section of Route 66 realize
11 more than 12 million annual visitors with more than \$1 billion in
12 direct earnings due to travel and support more than 46,000 jobs
13 directly related to travel and tourism; and

14 WHEREAS, in 2023, the Oklahoma Legislature created the Oklahoma
15 Route 66 Commission to provide grants for historic preservation and
16 economic development in communities along the road and over \$21
17 million has been awarded to date; and

18 WHEREAS, the Oklahoma Route 66 Centennial Commission has planned
19 special events throughout 2026 including the largest centennial
20 celebration in the nation on May 30.

21 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
22 OF THE 2ND SESSION OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE, THE SENATE
23 CONCURRING THEREIN:
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1 THAT the Oklahoma House and Senate recognize April 21, 2026, as
2 Route 66 Day at the Capitol.

3 THAT the Oklahoma House and Senate celebrate the one hundredth
4 anniversary of Route 66 and the many Oklahomans throughout the years
5 who have contributed to its success.

6 THAT the Oklahoma House and Senate offer sincere thanks to the
7 Oklahoma Route 66 Centennial Commission and the Oklahoma Route 66
8 Commission and their partner agencies.

9 THAT copies of this resolution be distributed to Lt. Governor
10 Matt Pinnell, chairman of the Oklahoma Route 66 Centennial
11 Commission, and Thomas Tillison, chairman of the Oklahoma Route 66
12 Commission.

13 Adopted by the House of Representatives the 21st day of April,
14 2026.

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Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

Adopted by the Senate the ____ day of _____, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate